

# **Relationships & Communication Workshop with SAPAC!**

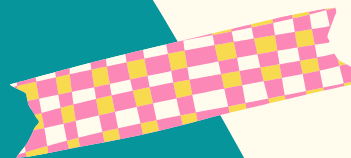


A presentation for ALA 240

Sexual Assault Prevention and  
Awareness Center

University of Michigan Ann Arbor

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✦ The **Sexual Assault Prevention and Awareness Center** offers prevention education for students, confidential support for survivors, those supporting survivors, and those looking for resources (students, faculty, and staff). We collaborate with other offices to offer training, programs, and innovative community engagement strategies to collectively create a campus free from violence.

Come visit us on the 4th floor of the Union! You can also make an appointment with an advocate or request a workshop through our website.

Crisis Line: (734) 936-3333

# Questions?

We'll have a box for questions, feel free to write down your question - with or without a name! - and we'll spend some time answering them at the end.



# TODAY'S Agenda

Intros!

Quiet Reflection about What Influences  
Sexuality

Healthy Relationships Activity

Frameworks for Thinking about Sexuality and  
Relationships

Skill Application through PACE Activity

Ending Reflection on Relationships on Campus

Conclusion and Wrap Up!



**We hope this workshop will be a space for you to engage in peer led conversations about sexuality and relationships, which you may or may not have engaged with before coming to college.**

**We recognize that regardless of previous experience this workshop is the start of a larger conversation and deeper understanding.**

**Our goal is that you walk away feeling empowered to continue to have these discussions and deepen personal understanding beyond this space.**





# Community Space

In this space, we encourage. . .

courage to accomplish learning goals, genuine dialogue on this topic of healthy relationships and communication; participating honestly to both teach and learn together; comfort expressing yourself fully without fear of attack, ridicule, or denial of experience.

We acknowledge that authentic learning often requires vulnerability and we seek to make this as warm and welcoming space as possible.

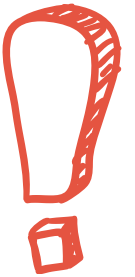
What is going to be helpful for you to be able to contribute and engage in this discussion on healthy relationships?



# Opening Journal Questions

Up until now, who or what influenced how you define sex and sexuality?

*Think: Family, Friends, Media, Religion...*



What is your definition of sex and sexuality?

*Sexuality meaning. . . our values and beliefs, bodies, desires, relationships, gender, etc.*

What feelings do you associate with the topic of sexuality?



What are your top 5 relationship moments (any close relationship - can be platonic or romantic)?

Context: What did the person do? What did it look like? what did it feel like? What did it sound like?

1.

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2.

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3.

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4.

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5.

# Helpful Tools for You!

The four frameworks are only briefly discussed here, and we'll have additional resources on each one in the virtual resources sent after the workshop! Our focus is to provide variety and to engage the different strengths of each one. These aren't mutually exclusive, so they absolutely can be combined with each other.

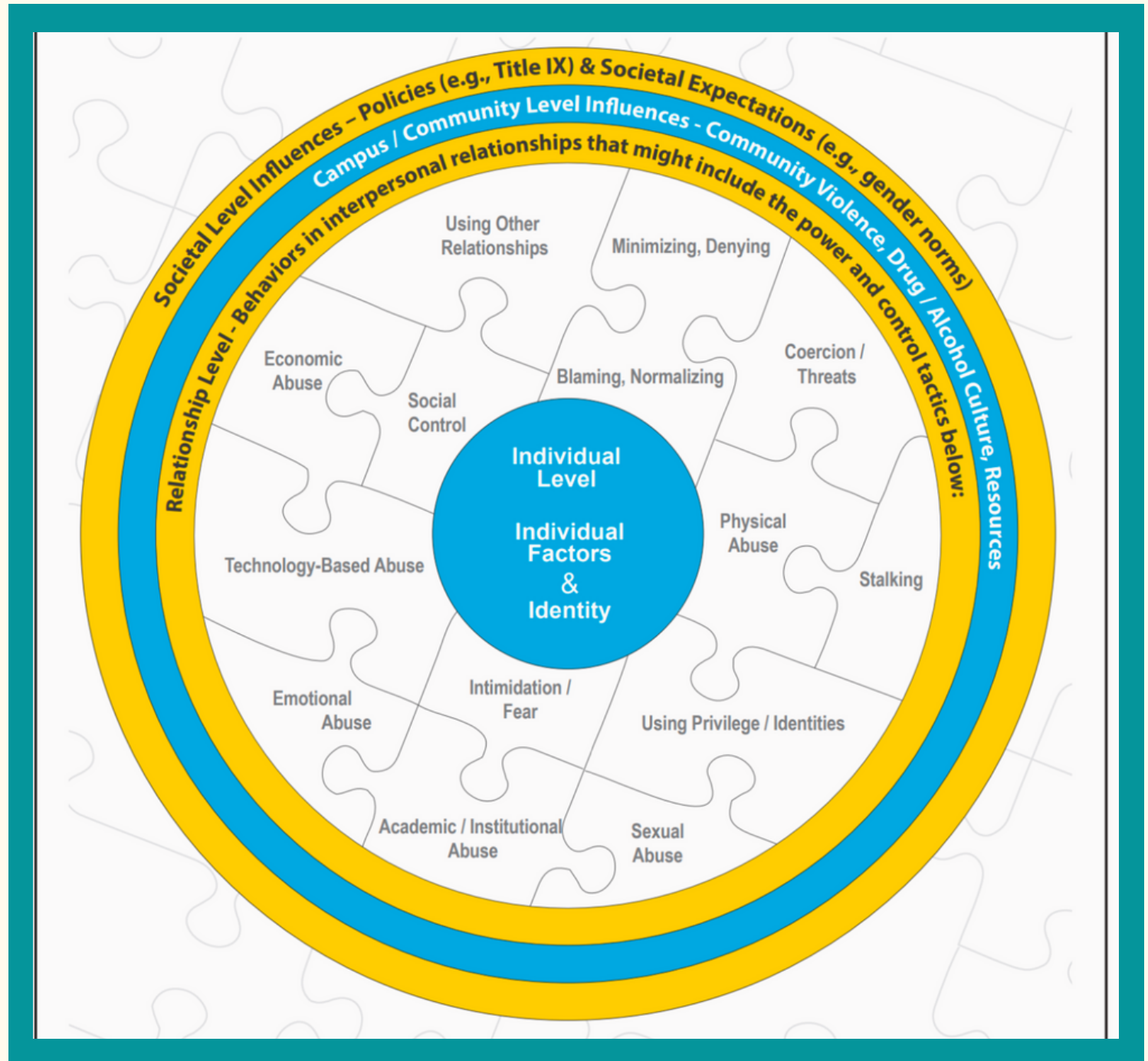
## RIDHA

RIDHA Model Developed by HEART (2018)

|                |                                          |                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|----------------|------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Rahma</b>   | Rooted in compassion and mutual pleasure | This means that intimate relationships and the physical, spiritual, and emotional intimacy people find in them are a divine gift - a mercy - to be cherished and nourished.                |
| <b>'Ilm</b>    | Informed by communication and knowledge  | This means that open, honest communication, usually face-to-face, is key between partners to uphold informed consent, build trust, and facilitate ongoing connection.                      |
| <b>'Adalah</b> | Driven by equity and fairness            | This means that a relationship which reflects equality, and integrity, and honor, senses of shared power and privilege will help create a healthy partnership based in fairness.           |
| <b>Hurma</b>   | Housed in safety and security            | This means that a relationship should provide each partner with a stable sense of safety and security. Threats, fear, and intimidation are in conflict with ideals of love and mercy.      |
| <b>Aqd</b>     | Affirmed in commitment and fidelity      | This means that sexual intimacy is possible only where a clear agreement between partners exists. This supports sexual intimacy as a sacred, spiritual, and mutually beneficial experience |



# Power & Control Wheel



Power and Control  
Wheel-Model  
developed by Michelle  
Munro Kramer et al.  
(2022.)



# FRIES

## Model of Consent

FRIES Model of Consent-Developed  
by Planned Parenthood

**Freely Given** – without pressure, manipulation or control, or while drunk or high.

**Reversible** – we can change our minds at any time, even in the middle of sex.

**Informed** – everyone knows exactly what they're getting into, and there are no surprises.

**Enthusiastic** – a firm, happy 'yes'. Not a 'maybe' or 'I guess'.

**Specific** – agreeing to each sexual act, each and every time.



# P.A.C.E.

P.A.C.E. Model developed by FYRST Prevention Team (2023)

|          |              |                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|----------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>P</b> | Power        | This means visible and invisible methods of controlling the environment and behavior of others                                                                                                          |
| <b>A</b> | Agency       | This means individual and group actions taken to intervene in the environment or behavior of others                                                                                                     |
| <b>C</b> | Culture      | This means conscious or subconscious, verbal or nonverbal patterns of communicating values and norms; a shared way of life of a group of people that they accept, generally without thinking about them |
| <b>E</b> | Expectations | This means clear, conscious boundaries dictating the ideal conditions under which something will happen or be the case in the future                                                                    |

# Let's Practice



## Scenario #1

When I moved to the States, I was treated badly by American college students at UM because my friends and I held hands. It is normal and custom where I come from for men to hold hands and show affection. But my classmates would ask if we were dating or sleeping together.

Some of my friends and I talked about it and decided that it was worth the teasing to engage in our familiar ways of interacting. But some of my friends dodge the conversations and we've become distant because of this.

## Scenario #2

Every weekend, there is a group of my friends that goes out pretty regularly. In the last couple of weeks, there has been this other first-year joining from my floor that I only know by acquaintance, Alex. My friends and I have noticed that Alex drinks the most in our group and can have a hard time reading the room. At a party, I noticed that there was this older-looking individual approaching us and hitting on Alex, who is pretty drunk by this point. Later in the night, I see Alex about to leave with this new person. Our friends have been saying that they feel uncomfortable because Alex has been drinking but we don't know Alex that well. We're not sure what to do. I remembered some of my training on being a bystander - like direct, distract, delegate, delay - but I'm not sure what would be effective.

# Let's Practice



## Scenario #3



A faculty member from my department requested to follow me on Facebook. Several people told me that it's normal but I wasn't really sure. Some of my family thought that it was harmless, and a good way to stay in contact for things like recommendation letters and just keeping in touch. Other family members told me it was a sign of predatory behavior and they shouldn't be trusted. I lost some sleep and was nervous for a long time. I eventually accepted the friend request after I graduated.

## Scenario #4



I met this graduate student on Hinge and we hit it off right away, despite the fact that I'm still a first-year. He asked to take me out for pizza and agreed. After pizza, he mentioned that his apartment was only 15 minutes away. Although he would drive there, it was about a 20-minute walk from my dorm when we were only 5 minutes from my dorm right now. I thought about inviting him back to my dorm not really wanting to walk alone at night but not sure if I should because I only have a bed in my dorm. I am concerned with the message that it sends inviting him back to sit on my bed because I am not sure I'm interested in sex at this point in time.

# Let's Practice



## Scenario #5

My roommate and I went out to Necto on Friday night to see a drag queen perform. My roommate brought her girlfriend, who kept making suggestive comments about the Puerto Rican queen being “hot and spicy” and trying to touch the drag queen on stage. I tried to jokingly tell her girlfriend to stop since she hadn’t asked the performer if she could, but my roommate’s girlfriend replied that “it’s different in gay clubs” and I wouldn’t understand as I just came out. I want to talk to my roommate about the uncomfortable racial comments and lack of consent but I don’t want to alienate one of my first queer friends.

## Scenario #6

My boyfriend and I have a healthy sex life and usually end our stressful week with a date night on Fridays. After dinner this week, I started to take the night where it would usually go and climbed in his lap. After some kissing, I noticed he wasn’t as enthusiastic as usual and wasn’t talking as much. I pulled back and asked what he wanted to do next. He told me that he felt guilty because he knew that we usually spent the night together and while he wanted to relax, he didn’t feel like having sex. At first, I felt self-conscious (don’t guys always want to have sex?) but I went to grab some water and we ended up having a conversation about what things he wanted to do that night (yes to cuddling, no to kissing) and how we could feel connected in other ways. We ended up watching the movie we did on our first date and talking about our plans for the future. It wasn’t what I expected but we promised to explore more ways to connect that weren’t just sex.



## **Instructions for the activity:**

Get up and go to your group's assigned example in the room!

For 5 minutes, use P.A.C.E. to analyze behavior in the first scenario.  
Take notes about what people say on the P.A.C.E. half!

After the facilitators assign a new example to you, you'll move on to that scenario and use F.R.I.E.S. to analyze behavior. Take notes!

At the end of the activity, a volunteer from each group will share what you worked on.

a. How did PACE go?

b. How was FRIES relevant?

## To finish our time together, let's use what we've practiced today to look at some of the relationships you might have at UM!

This chart can help you organize which behaviors and styles of communication are healthy and unhealthy for you, depending on the relationship you have with the person. The things you put in different boxes can change as you learn more about yourself and others.



How does PACE or FRIES apply to these relationships? How might PACE empower or disempower you?



With a Professor

With a family member

With a romantic partner

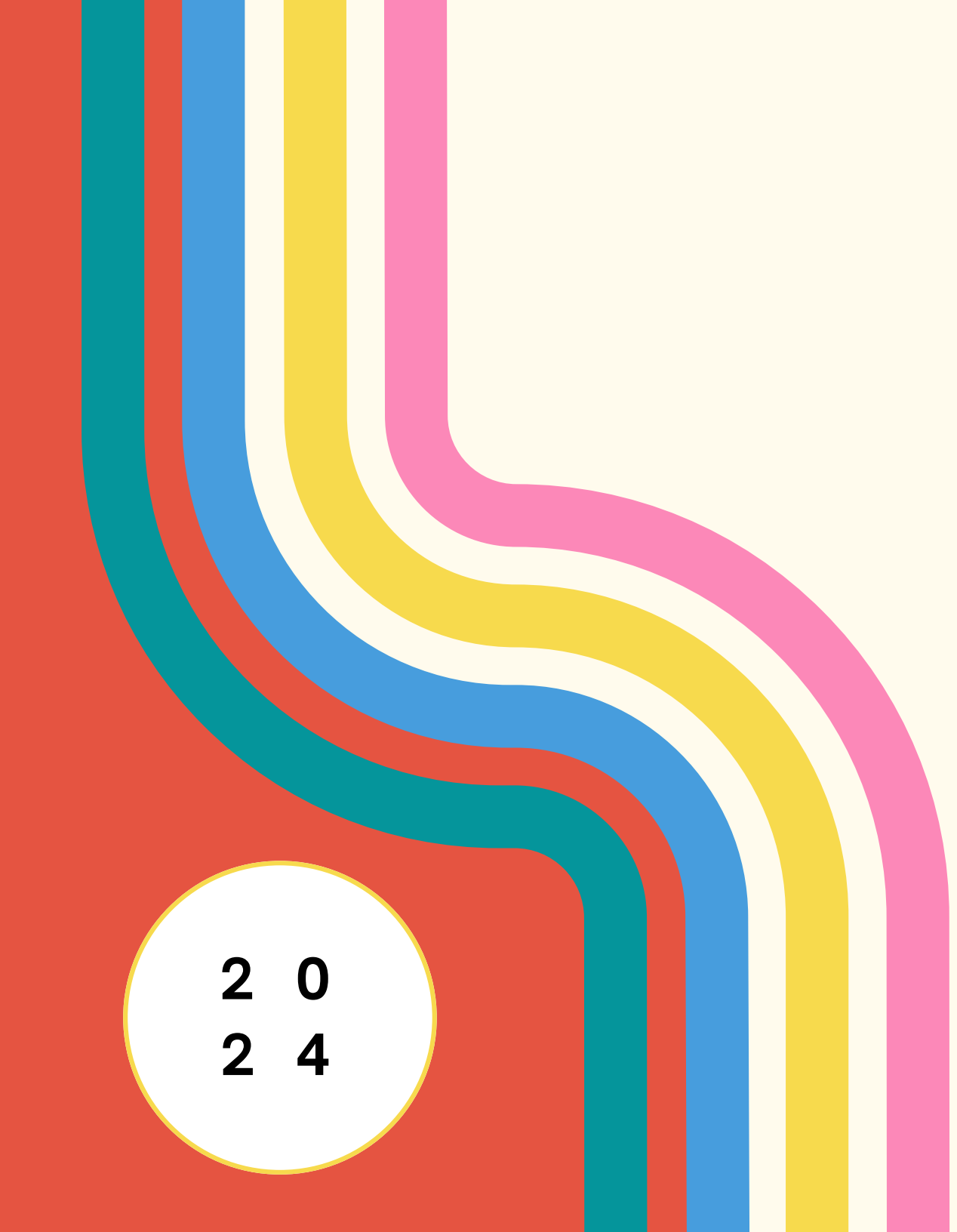
With a sexual partner

With a friendship

With a roommate

With a supervisor





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# THANK YOU!

Please come help yourself to  
resources.